DTU Skylab × TUH Skylab at Rigshospitalet

The TUH Skylab Innovation Pipeline

Every course, programme, facility and grant a health-tech idea can use, from a clinical need to a scaling company, and what it takes to get in.

Internal overview · October 2026

The pipeline at a glance

Five phases, one programme spine

01

Need

Find a real clinical problem

Before the programme

Needfinding at the Hospital · Minisprint with Clinicians

02

Explore

Ideate and form a team

Open-Door Coaching is the way in

Healthtech Hackathon · EXPLORE · Health Innovators

03

Build

Prototype and test with users

Stage 1, Discover

Rapid Prototyping in the Clinic · TUH Skylab makerspace · Skylab Funding

04

Incubate

MVP, business model, company

Stage 2, Validate · ends with a CVR

Developer Hall · MedTech Growth · PoC · InnoExplorer

05

Scale

Company in the market

Stage 3, Launch Pad (coming)

SkyFactory · BII Venture Lab · Science Park

Sources: skylab.dtu.dk, tuh.dtu.dk, DTU course base, internal TUH programme plan · checked 1 Oct 2026 · 2

Who gets in

Five rules filter teams more than anything else

1. **A DTU person on the team.** Skylab funding, programmes and facilities need a DTU student or employee. Clinicians need a DTU co-founder, or BETA.HEALTH.

2. **Open Door is the only way in.** The Startup Programme has no application form. Teams pitch at an Open-Door Coaching Session.

3. **Researcher grants are staff-only.** Discovery needs Stage 1 and PoC needs Stage 2, and both are for DTU employees only.

4. **Time the CVR.** InnoExplorer only funds projects before a CVR exists. Skylab Funding needs one within 3 months of the award.

5. **Some offers need a company.** Life Science Academy, SkyFactory, MedTech Growth, BII and Innofounder all need a CVR.

Sources: skylab.dtu.dk, tuh.dtu.dk, DTU course base, internal TUH programme plan · checked 1 Oct 2026 · 3

Phases 01–02 · Need and explore

Almost everything is open or only needs DTU enrolment

Offer	Run by	Who can join	When
Needfinding at the Hospital	DTU course	DTU MSc students, 5 ECTS	Autumn
Minisprint with Clinicians *(planned)*	TUH Skylab	DTU students and clinicians	Autumn
Info / In-Flight Session	DTU Skylab	Open to all	Recurring
Innovation in Engineering *(fit to confirm)*	DTU course 42500	All DTU MSc; projects often predefined	January
Healthtech Hackathon *(planned)*	TUH Skylab	Students, ~40 places	Spring, autumn
EXPLORE	Skylab, CBS, KU	Any Danish university	Twice a year
OpenInnovation	DTU, KU, CBS	Any Danish institution	Yearly
Health Innovators	CHI and partners	Any Danish institution, 30 places	Feb 2027
Pre-incubation *(planned)*	DTU Skylab	DTU students	Jan, June
Open-Door Coaching	DTU Skylab	DTU students and staff, no form	Recurring

Sources: skylab.dtu.dk, tuh.dtu.dk, DTU course base, internal TUH programme plan · checked 1 Oct 2026 · CHI: copenhagenhealthinnovation.dk · 4

Phase 03 · Build

Prototype next to the clinic, inside Stage 1

Offer	Run by	Who can join	When
Rapid Prototyping in the Clinic	Rigshospitalet, TUH Skylab	DTU students, 5 or 10 ECTS	Spring
X-Tech Entrepreneurship	DTU course 38103	~24 places; sponsor may take IP	Spring
Feasibility Study	DTU course	~12 places, ECTS to confirm	Autumn
TUH Skylab makerspace	TUH Skylab	Engineers, clinicians, students	Ongoing
Stage 1, Discover	DTU Skylab	Via Open Door	Up to 6 months
Workshops & Tech Support	DTU Skylab	DTU projects; register first	Ongoing
BETA.HEALTH	University hospitals	Hospital-employed project lead	Call end 2026
NNF Pioneer Innovator	Novo Nordisk Fdn.	Nordic researchers, before CVR	Jan 2027
KU Lighthouse Launch	KU Lighthouse	KU students and researchers	Twice a year

Sources: skylab.dtu.dk, tuh.dtu.dk, DTU course base, internal TUH programme plan · checked 1 Oct 2026 · betahealth.dk · novonordiskfonden.dk · lighthouse.ku.dk · 5

Phases 04–05 · Incubate and scale

After the CVR line, almost everything needs a company

Offer	Run by	Who can join	When
X-Tech+ · Due Diligence	DTU courses	ECTS to confirm, 6–12 places	Autumn, June
Stage 2, Validate	DTU Skylab	Stage 1 done; ends with a CVR	6–12 months
Developer Hall · Prototype2Market	DTU Skylab	Active DTU prototype work	3-month terms
MedTech Growth	DTU Science Park	MDR/IVDR device firms, DKK 30k fee	Yearly
Advisory Days	DTU Skylab	Free legal, accounting and IP advice	Spring, autumn
Innofounder	Innovation Fund DK	Graduates, full-time, CVR ≤ 3 yrs	Spring 2027
BII Venture Lab	BioInnovation Inst.	CVR, no prior investors	Cohort Mar 2027
Life Science Academy	Interreg ÖKS	Life-science founders, CVR	Rolling
DTU SkyFactory	Skylab, Science Park, PSV	CVR, by selection	Pilot since 2025
Stage 3, Launch Pad	DTU Skylab	Not published yet	Coming

Sources: skylab.dtu.dk, tuh.dtu.dk, DTU course base, internal TUH programme plan · checked 1 Oct 2026 · dtusciencepark.com · bii.dk · innovationsfonden.dk · 6

Funding

Who applies and the CVR decide which grant fits

Grant	DKK	Who applies	Stage	CVR rule	Next round
Skylab Funding	15–150k	≥1 DTU founder	None	CVR within 3 months	Spring 2027
Discovery Grant	≤ 100k	DTU staff	Stage 1	Pre-company	12 Oct 2026
Proof of Concept	≤ 500k	DTU staff	Stage 2	Not with InnoExplorer	4 Nov 2026
InnoExplorer	0.5–1.5M	Research projects	Stage 2	Only before CVR	Early 2027
NNF Pioneer Innovator	≤ 1.2M	Nordic researchers	None	Held by institution	Jan 2027
BETA.HEALTH	0.5–1M	Hospital-employed lead	None	Pre-company	End 2026
Innofounder	27.5k/mo each	Graduates, full-time	None	CVR at start, ≤ 3 yrs	Spring 2027
BII Venture Lab	4.2M loan	Danish startups	None	CVR before money	Mar 2027

Sources: Skylab Funding FAQ, Discovery, PoC, InnoExplorer pages, betahealth.dk, novonordiskfonden.dk, innovationsfonden.dk, bii.dk · deadlines as of 1 Oct 2026 · 7

The CVR line

Registering a company is a one-way door

Before the CVR

InnoExplorer (only here), Discovery, NNF Pioneer Innovator, BETA.HEALTH, the Skylab Funding application, Stages 1–2, all courses and events.

Register

Within 3 months of a Skylab Funding award, or normally at the end of Stage 2. A verified spin-out also counts.

After the CVR

Skylab Funding payout, Innofounder (3-year clock starts), BII Venture Lab, MedTech Growth, Life Science Academy, SkyFactory.

Sources: Skylab Funding FAQ, InnoExplorer page, Innofounder guidelines Jan 2026, BII Venture Lab guidelines Apr 2026 · 8

Beyond DTU

Where external rules clash with Skylab's

CVR order

Innofounder needs a company under 3 years old. An early CVR for Skylab Funding starts that clock.

Full-time

Innofounder allows at most 10 hours a week of other work. That rules out finishing a degree or a clinical job.

Investors

BII excludes teams with prior commercial investors, so a pre-seed ticket first can block BII.

IP

Hospital staff must disclose inventions to Region H Tech Trans. BETA.HEALTH and BII need clear IP.

Sources: innovationsfonden.dk (Innofounder guidelines), bii.dk (Venture Lab guidelines), regionh.dk, betahealth.dk · 9

Design choice

Which academic activities belong on the map?

Option A

Every DTU innovation course

Complete, but it turns the map into a catalogue that goes stale quickly.

Option B · chosen

Courses with a clinical or venture hand-off

They must work with clinicians, or produce a team or prototype that could become a startup, and have an owner who keeps dates current. Seven courses plus the MSc thesis.

Option C

No courses at all

Cleanest, but it hides the main way students arrive.

Open questions

Nine things to settle before this goes wider

- Who can use the TUH Skylab makerspace, and how to book it
- Owner, dates and sign-up for the planned items
- Course codes and ECTS for Feasibility Study, Due Diligence, X-Tech+
- Is Prototype2Market still running? Its page is offline
- Content and entry rules for Stage 3, Launch Pad
- A clinical pilot pathway: agreement, data, device rules
- Regional invention rules for clinician co-founders
- Can recent DTU graduates join Stage 1?
- Can Innovation in Engineering take health-tech projects? Its projects tend to be predefined

DTU Skylab

Advisory Days
skylab.dtu.dk/For-Startups/Advisory-Days

Bevica Seed Grants
skylab.dtu.dk/For-Students/Projects-and-Programmes/Technology-leaving-no-one-behind/Innovation-and-Entrepreneurship/Bevica-Seed-Grants

Developer Hall
skylab.dtu.dk/Facilities/Developer-Hall

Discovery Grants
skylab.dtu.dk/for-researchers/dtu-discovery-grants

European Venture Programme
skylab.dtu.dk/For-Students/Projects-and-Programmes/European-Venture-Programme

EXPLORE
skylab.dtu.dk/For-Students/Projects-and-Programmes/Explore

For Startups (overview)
skylab.dtu.dk/for-startups

InnoExplorer Grants
skylab.dtu.dk/for-researchers/dtu-innoexplorer-grants

Life Science Academy for Startups
skylab.dtu.dk/For-Students/Projects-and-Programmes/Life-Science-Academy

OpenInnovation
skylab.dtu.dk/For-Students/Projects-and-Programmes/Open-Innovation

Pre-startup Mentoring
skylab.dtu.dk/For-Startups/Pre-startup-mentoring

Projects and Programmes (students)
skylab.dtu.dk/For-Students/Projects-and-Programmes

Proof of Concept Grants
skylab.dtu.dk/for-researchers/dtu-proof-of-concept-grants

Skylab Funding, incl. FAQ
skylab.dtu.dk/For-Startups/Skylab-Funding

Skylab Minisprint
skylab.dtu.dk/For-Students/Projects-and-Programmes/Skylab-Minisprint

Startup Programme (Stages 1–3)
skylab.dtu.dk/For-Startups/Skylab-Startup-Programme

Tech Development Support
skylab.dtu.dk/Facilities/Get-tech-development-support

Vissing Fonden (excluded, not health)
skylab.dtu.dk/For-Startups/Skylab-Funding/Vissing-Fonden

Wall of Opportunity
skylab.dtu.dk/For-Students/Projects-and-Programmes/Wall-of-Opportunity

Workshops
skylab.dtu.dk/Facilities/Workshops

Sources · 2 of 3

DTU, TUH Skylab and the internal plan

DTU course base (Needfinding at the Hospital, 42500, 38103) · *Course facts partly from search results*
dtu.dk/english/education/course-base

DTU Innovation in Engineering
dtu.dk/english/education/graduate/innovation-in-engineering

DTU Science Park, MedTech Growth
dtusciencepark.com/startup-services/medtech_growth/

DTU SkyFactory announcement (Oct 2025)
dtu.dk/english/newsarchive/2025/10/new-entrepreneurial-hub-to-make-one-in-ten-dtu-start-ups-a-growth-company

DTU X-Tech Entrepreneurship
entrepreneurship.dtu.dk/education/x-tech-entrepreneurship

MedTech Product Development special course · *LinkedIn post, seen in search results only*
linkedin.com

TUH Skylab
tuh.dtu.dk/en/TUH-Skylab

TUH "Health Tech Innovator Phases" programme plan · *Internal screenshot, programmes_and_courses.png*
Internal, not public

Sources · 3 of 3

Beyond DTU

BETA.HEALTH, apply
betahealth.dk/apply

BII Venture Lab guidelines (Apr 2026)
bii.dk/media/o1npxoy0/guidelines-for-applicants_venture-lab_april2026.pdf

Copenhagen Health Innovation, Health Innovators
copenhagenhealthinnovation.dk/health-innovators/

Copenhagen School of Entrepreneurship
cse.cbs.dk/students/

CPH MedTech
cphmedtech.dk

EIT Health Catapult
eithealth.eu/programmes/catapult/

EIT Jumpstarter terms 2026 · *Used to exclude it*
eitjumpstarter.eu

Health Tech Hub Copenhagen
healthtechhub.org/for-startups/

InnoBooster
danmarksinnovationsfond.dk/en/p/innobooster

Innofounder guidelines (Jan 2026)
innovationsfonden.dk/sites/default/files/2026-01/Innofounder%20retningslinjer%2001.01.26.pdf

KU Lighthouse, students
lighthouse.ku.dk/en/students/

Novo Nordisk Foundation, Pioneer Innovator Grant
novonordiskfonden.dk/en/grant/pioneer-innovator-grant/

Region Hovedstaden, commercialising inventions · *Page behind a bot check; search results only*
regionh.dk

Venture Cup Denmark · *Could not be reached on 1 Oct 2026*
venturecup.dk